

Azure Cloud Governance Policy

Helios Energy Analytics Ltd - practical policy document for Azure governance, tagging, regions and storage security.

Purpose

This policy defines the minimum governance controls for Azure resources within the Helios environment. It supports accountability, security baseline enforcement, cost visibility and audit readiness.

Scope

Applies to Azure subscriptions, resource groups and resources created for the Helios governance lab and any future project extensions.

Policy Requirements

- All resources must include an Owner tag to identify the accountable person or team.
- Approved regions are UK South and UK West unless an exemption is documented and approved.
- Storage accounts must not allow public blob access unless there is a formal business justification.
- Storage accounts should enforce secure transfer.
- Network rules must avoid unrestricted inbound management access.

Enforcement Model

Azure Policy is used to enforce and monitor compliance. Deny is used for mandatory controls where non-compliance should be prevented. Audit is used where monitoring and remediation are more appropriate.

Exceptions

Any exception must document the business reason, risk owner, expiry date, compensating control and approval record. Exceptions should be reviewed monthly.

Evidence

Evidence should be stored in the project evidence repository, including screenshots, compliance snapshots, Resource Graph outputs and remediation notes.

Prepared as part of the Helios Azure Cloud Governance & GRC portfolio case study.